

Fearghal Ó Floinn

Senior Site Reliability Engineer

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About

Site Reliability Engineer with more than 14 years of experience designing, building, and operating highly available infrastructure. I work across cloud platforms, automation, and security best practices, and I enjoy mentoring engineers and guiding projects to successful completion in complex operational settings.

Based in Ireland, I bring a practical, end-to-end perspective shaped by experience across engineering, infrastructure operations, and large-scale services.

Experience

Microsoft

Senior Site Reliability Engineer

June 2022 - Present · Dublin, Ireland

I work on the reliability and operation of large-scale cloud services used by customers around the world, with a focus on service health, effective incident response, and sustainable improvements.

- **Reliability targets:** define service level indicators and objectives that reflect business needs and help sustain very high availability.
- **Observability:** improve monitoring and metrics, and build actionable alerts across public and specialized cloud environments, including synthetic monitoring and cost-conscious logging.
- **Automation and delivery:** develop build and release pipelines, improve metric and monitor creation with scripting, and update service code to make reliability signals more accurate.
- **Infrastructure and security:** design and maintain highly available infrastructure, apply security best practices across layers, and lead migrations of services from on-premises to the cloud.
- **Incident response:** take part in 24/7 on-call as responder and incident manager, keeping recovery times low and sharing what is learned.
- **Innovation:** explore applying artificial intelligence to monitoring and incident management.

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Principal Site Reliability Engineer

August 2016 - June 2022 · Dublin, Ireland

- Provided advanced support for critical services as part of the Tier 3 infrastructure team.
- Administered monitoring, automation, and deployment tooling including Splunk, Nagios, Ansible Tower, Rundeck, Jenkins, and Sensu, and managed image and configuration lifecycles.
- Directed the migration of on-premises infrastructure and applications to the cloud with comprehensive monitoring, and built secure host access for virtual machines.
- Engineered new environments for development teams, administered the CDN, reviewed change management, and mentored junior engineers.

Projects

A selection of reliability, observability, and migration projects from my career, plus this site.

Microsoft

Service observability and reliability targets

Defined service level indicators and objectives and improved the signals behind them for large-scale cloud services.

- Built actionable monitors and improved metric accuracy and cardinality in service code.
- Automated metric and monitor creation with scripting to make coverage consistent and repeatable.

Observability for specialized cloud environments

Extended monitoring and alerting to isolated cloud environments with their own operational constraints.

- Introduced synthetic monitoring to detect customer-facing problems before they were reported.

Monitoring and logging cost reduction

Reduced the cost of the metrics and logging platform while preserving the visibility teams rely on.

- Reviewed data volume and retention to remove low-value telemetry.

On-premises to cloud service migration

Led the migration of multiple microservices from on-premises infrastructure to the cloud.

- Designed highly available infrastructure with security best practices applied across layers.
- Built build and release pipelines that meet security and code review standards.

Observability for an AI tooling (MCP) service

Helped bring a Model Context Protocol service used by AI assistants under proper reliability and monitoring coverage.

- Defined SLIs and SLOs and built actionable monitors for the service.
- Improved telemetry so usage, errors and latency could be understood quickly.

AI-assisted monitoring and incident management

Using GitHub Copilot and agent tooling day to day to speed up investigation, automation and incident workflows.

- Applying Copilot and custom agents to triage, query generation and monitor authoring.
- Building reusable skills and runbooks so investigations are consistent and auditable.

NortonLifeLock

Ansible Tower to Rundeck migration

Migrated automation workflows from Ansible Tower to Rundeck.

- Moved operational jobs and runbooks to a platform better suited to the team.
- Kept configuration management in Ansible while simplifying how jobs are scheduled and run.

Monitoring platform with Sensu

Implemented comprehensive monitoring using Sensu alongside tools such as Nagios and Splunk.

- Gave the team clearer, more actionable alerting across services and hosts.

Migration of on-premises services to Azure

Directed the migration of on-premises infrastructure and applications to the cloud.

- Added monitoring to the migrated services and built secure host access for virtual machines.

Personal

Self-hosted portfolio platform

This site: a custom WordPress theme run in Docker on a small home server, with the whole setup defined in Git so it can be rebuilt from a single script.

- Docker Compose, Nginx with automatic HTTPS, rate limiting, and administration reachable only through a private SSH tunnel.
- Status: live and maintained.

Education

Institute of Technology Blanchardstown

Bachelor of Engineering (Honours) in Mechatronics

2005 - 2010 · Result: 2.1

Certifications

- Red Hat Certified System Administrator (RHCSA)
- Mirantis Certified Administrator for OpenStack
- VMware Certified Associate - Data Center Virtualization (VCA-DCV)
- Storage Administrator, VNX Solutions Specialist Version 7.0 (EMCSA)
- Information Storage Associate Version 2 (EMCISA)
- Cisco Certified Entry Networking Technician (CCENT)

Skills

- **Cloud and containers** Azure, AWS, GCP, Kubernetes (AKS, EKS), Helm
- **Infrastructure as code and automation** Terraform, Bicep, Ansible, Puppet
- **Languages and scripting** Python, Bash, PowerShell, Go, Perl, Ruby
- **CI/CD and source control** Git, Azure DevOps, GitLab, Jenkins, Perforce
- **Monitoring and logging** Grafana, Prometheus, Azure Monitor, Sensus, Nagios, Splunk, Log Analytics, Elasticsearch
- **Operating systems** Ubuntu, Red Hat, CentOS, SUSE, Azure Linux, Windows Server, ESXi
- **Networking, storage, and CDN** Azure networking, Cisco, Juniper, Extreme, Vyatta, EMC and HP storage, SAN zoning, Akamai, Azure CDN
- **Practice** incident response, production support, network security, backup solutions